4. Environment and Forestry
5. Science and Technology and Meteorology
6. Human Resources Development
7. Transport.

High-level working groups have also been established to strengthen cooperation in the areas of Information and Communications Technology, Biotechnology, Intellectual Property Rights, Tourism and Energy.

Objectives of the Association

The objectives of the Association, as defined in the Charter, are to:

1. Promote the welfare of the peoples of South Asia and to improve their quality of life.
2. Accelerate economic growth, social progress and cultural development in the region and to provide all individuals the opportunity to live in dignity and to realize their full potential.
3. Promote and strengthen collective self-reliance among the countries of South Asia.
4. Contribute to mutual trust, understanding and appreciation of one another's problems.
5. Promote active collaboration and mutual assistance in the economic, social, cultural, technical and scientific fields.
6. Strengthen cooperation with other developing countries.
7. Strengthen cooperation among themselves in international forums on matters of common interest.
8. Cooperate with international and regional organizations with similar aims and purposes.

Principles

The Principles enshrined in the Charter are:

1. Cooperation within the framework of the Association is based on respect for the principles of sovereign equality, territorial integrity, political independence, non-interference in the internal affairs of other states, and mutual benefit.
2. Such cooperation is to complement and not to substitute